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## ENGLISH

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# Sonnet 116 - William Shakespeare

## A Note On The Poet :

William Shakespeare (1564-1616) was born in Stratford-upon-Avon. He is widely regarded as the most excellent writer in the English language and the world's pre-eminent dramatist. He is also known as the "Bard of Avon". He is the most famous and influential playwright in English literature. He wrote thirty-seven plays, one hundred fifty-four sonnets and two epic poems. His sonnets explore themes of love, beauty, politics, and mortality, demonstrating his exceptional skill in poetic form.

He has written comedies, tragedies and historical plays. Some of his famous plays are "A Midsummer Night's Dream," "Hamlet," "Othello," "King Lear," and "Macbeth". His plays have been translated into every major living language and are performed more often than those of any other playwright.

## Sonnet 116 Summary :

### Introduction :

Shakespeare's Sonnet 116 is a profound reflection on the nature of true love. The poet defines love as an unwavering, eternal force that remains constant despite external changes. Below is a detailed analysis of the poem, including its meaning, themes, and literary devices.

### First Quatrain (Lines 1–4): The Definition of True Love

**"Let me not to the marriage of true minds / Admit impediments."**

Shakespeare begins with a strong assertion that nothing should stand in the way of true love. "Marriage of true minds" suggests a deep, spiritual connection rather than just a legal or physical bond. The phrase "admit impediments" alludes to the Christian wedding ceremony, where the priest asks if anyone knows of a reason the couple should not be married. Shakespeare argues that true love should have no barriers.

**"Love is not love / Which alters when it alteration finds, / Or bends with the remover to remove."**

Here, he defines love by what it is not. If love changes when circumstances change or disappears when someone leaves, then it was never true love to begin with. True love is steadfast and does not waver in the face of challenges.

### **Second Quatrain (Lines 5–8): Love as a Guiding Force**

**"O no! it is an ever-fixed mark / That looks on tempests and is never shaken;"**

Love is compared to a lighthouse ("ever-fixed mark"), a guiding structure that remains strong despite powerful storms ("tempests"). This metaphor suggests that true love is unshaken by hardships, trials, or difficulties.

**"It is the star to every wandering bark, / Whose worth's unknown, although his height be taken."**

Love is also compared to the North Star, a constant celestial guide for lost sailors ("wandering bark" means a ship). The line "whose worth's unknown" implies that love, like the star, has immeasurable value, though its position can be measured. This reinforces the idea that love provides direction and certainty in an uncertain world.

### **Third Quatrain (Lines 9–12): Love vs. Time**

**"Love's not Time's fool, though rosy lips and cheeks / Within his bending sickle's compass come;"**

Love is not subject to the power of time ("Time's fool"). The personification of Time with a sickle refers to the Grim Reaper, who cuts down youth and beauty. While physical beauty fades ("rosy lips and cheeks" age), true love remains unaffected by the passage of time.

**"Love alters not with his brief hours and weeks, / But bears it out even to the edge of doom."**

Love does not change, even over short or long periods. It lasts until "the edge of doom," meaning Judgment Day, implying that real love is eternal and transcends even death.

### **Final Couplet (Lines 13–14): Shakespeare's Bold Claim**

**"If this be error and upon me proved, / I never writ, nor no man ever loved."**

Shakespeare ends with a confident assertion: if his definition of love is wrong, then he has never written anything, and no one has ever truly loved. Since Shakespeare is a

widely acknowledged poet and love undeniably exists, this statement reinforces the truth of his argument.

## **Themes in the Poem :**

- 1. The Eternal Nature of Love :** Shakespeare presents love as unchanging and enduring. It does not waver with time, distance, or hardship. True love remains constant, regardless of external circumstances.
- 2. Love as a Guiding Force :** Love is depicted as a lighthouse and a guiding star, showing that it provides direction and stability in life. These metaphors suggest that love is reliable and offers security.
- 3. Love vs. Time :** The poem directly challenges the idea that time can diminish love. While physical beauty fades, love transcends the effects of aging and mortality.
- 4. Love as an Ideal Concept :** Shakespeare presents an almost perfect, idealized version of love. It is not affected by human weaknesses, emotional instability, or changes in circumstances. Instead, it remains pure and steadfast.

## **Literary Devices Used in the Poem :**

### **1. Metaphor :**

"It is an ever-fixed mark" (love as a lighthouse)

"It is the star to every wandering bark" (love as the North Star)

### **2. Personification :**

"Love's not Time's fool" (Love is personified as strong and independent of time.)

"Time's sickle" (Time is depicted as a reaper who cuts down youth and beauty.)

### **3. Alliteration :**

"Love alters not with his brief hours" (repetition of 'L' and 'H' sounds)

"Let me not to the marriage of true minds" (repetition of 'M' and 'T' sounds)

### **4. Hyperbole (Exaggeration) :**

"Bears it out even to the edge of doom" (Love lasting until Judgment Day is an exaggerated claim to emphasize its eternal nature.)

### **5. Irony :**

Shakespeare claims that if he is wrong, then he has never written anything an ironic statement since he is one of the greatest poets in history.

## **Conclusion :**

Sonnet 116 is one of Shakespeare's most famous love poems, presenting an idealistic and unwavering view of love. He argues that true love remains constant through all trials, unaffected by time or change. Using strong imagery and metaphors, he compares love to a lighthouse and the North Star, emphasizing its reliability. The poem's confident and assertive tone makes it a powerful declaration of love's eternal nature.

This sonnet is often quoted in weddings and romantic settings because of its timeless message about the power and resilience of true love.

## **I. Short Answer Questions.**

### **1.What does the poet not want to do?**

- a. believe that there is an obstacle to true love
- b. describe love
- c. talk about love
- d. talk about death

Ans: a. believe that there is an obstacle to true love

### **2.What is the central theme of the poem?**

Ans: The central theme of the poem is the unchanging and eternal nature of true love. Shakespeare emphasizes that real love does not alter with time, circumstances, or physical changes.

### **3.Which of the following does the poet not compare true love to?**

- a. a ship
- b. a red rose
- c. a star
- d. he doesn't compare it to anything

Ans: a. a red rose

### **4.What does the poet mean by 'wand'ring bark'?**

Ans: A "wand'ring bark" refers to a sailing ship that is lost or seeking direction. Shakespeare uses it as a metaphor for a person seeking guidance, and love is like the star that helps guide them.

### **5.What is the rhyme scheme of the first four lines of the poem?**

Ans: The rhyme scheme of the first four lines is ABAB.

Example:

A minds

B love

A finds

B remove

### **6.What implement does Time carry?**

- a. a pitchfork
- b. a scythe
- c. a compass
- d. a clock

Ans: b. a scythe

## II. Answer the following questions in about one page each.

### 1.Explain Shakespeare's idea that true love is not dependent on physical aspects.

Ans. In Sonnet 116, Shakespeare expresses that true love does not rely on physical beauty or outward appearances. He believes that love, if it is real, remains constant even when time changes a person's looks or circumstances. In the lines "Love is not love / Which alters when it alteration finds," he clearly states that love should not change just because something about the other person changes. He compares true love to an "ever-fixed mark," like a lighthouse that stays firm in storms, showing even during hard times. Shakespeare also says love is "not Time's fool," meaning it is not affected by aging or the passing of time. Through beauty may fade, true love remains unchanged. Overall, the poet presents love as spiritual, steady, and eternal not something based on appearance or temporary emotions.

### 2.List out all the different images in the sonnet and bring out their effectiveness.

Ans: Shakespeare uses several vivid images and metaphors in the sonnet to describe the nature of true love:

**"Ever-fixed mark"** – This refers to a lighthouse. It symbolizes love as a constant guide that stands firm through all storms.

**"Looks on tempests and is never shaken"** – This emphasizes that love stands strong during difficulties.

**"Star to every wand'ring bark"** – Love is compared to the North Star that guides lost ships. This image shows love as a dependable and eternal guide.

**"Time's sickle"** – Time is personified as a reaper with a sickle who cuts down beauty. This represents how time changes physical appearance.

**"Edge of doom"** – Refers to the end of the world or Judgment Day, implying that true love lasts even until death.

These images are powerful because they make the abstract concept of love more vivid, showing that love is strong, unchanging, and eternal.

### 3.What could be the possible changes that can come over people through the passage of Time, as suggested in Shakespeare's sonnet?

Ans: Shakespeare suggests that Time brings many changes in people. Physical beauty fades "rosy lips and cheeks" lose their charm with age. People grow older, weaker, and their appearances change. Emotions may become less intense, and circumstances in life may alter. However, despite all these changes, true love should not change. Even

though Time can take away youth and beauty, it cannot touch the soul or the depth of genuine love, which stays constant.

**4.What does the poet mean by ‘true minds’?**

Ans: The phrase “true minds” refers to people who are truly in love, not just physically attracted but connected at a deeper, intellectual and emotional level. Their union is not based on looks, wealth, or situation, but on genuine understanding and harmony of thought. Shakespeare believes that the marriage (union) of such minds should face no obstacles. This kind of love is unchanging and eternal.

**5.Can you explain the line ‘ever-fixed mark... never shaken’?**

Ans: In this line, Shakespeare compares true love to an ever-fixed mark, like a lighthouse or anchor that does not move even in a storm. “Never shaken” means it stays firm no matter what challenges arise. This metaphor shows that real love is unchangeable and reliable, unaffected by hardships or difficulties. It is a guiding force that remains stable through life’s storms.

**III. Answer the following questions in about one page each.**

**1.Explain Shakespeare’s idea that true love is not dependent on physical aspects.**

Ans: In Sonnet 116, Shakespeare expresses that true love does not rely on physical beauty or outward appearances. He believes that love, if it is real, remains constant even when time changes a person’s looks or circumstances. In the lines “Love is not love / Which alters when it alteration finds,” he clearly states that love should not change just because something about the other person changes. He compares true love to an “ever-fixed mark,” like a lighthouse that stays firm in storms, showing that love should remain strong even during hard times. Shakespeare also says love is “not Time’s fool,” meaning it is not affected by aging or the passing of time. Though beauty may fade, true love remains unchanged. Overall, the poet presents love as spiritual, steady, and eternal not something based on appearance or temporary emotions.

**2.What is the relevance of the last two lines to the meaning of the poem? What kind of role does the poet take on?**

Ans: The last two lines of Sonnet 116 are very important because they show the poet’s strong belief in his idea of true love. Shakespeare says, “If this be error and upon me proved, / I never writ, nor no man ever loved.” This means that if someone can prove his ideas about love wrong, then he never wrote anything, and no one has ever truly loved. These lines give the poem a powerful ending and show Shakespeare’s full confidence in his definition of love. He takes on the role of a wise thinker or judge, making a firm statement about love’s nature. The language in the final couplet is absolute and bold, adding strength to the message. It also makes the reader believe that the poet’s idea of love as something permanent and unchanging is deeply true and trustworthy.

### **3. Describe the poem as a meditative sonnet.**

Ans: Sonnet 116 is a meditative sonnet because it reflects deeply on the nature of love in a calm and thoughtful way. Shakespeare is not emotional or dramatic in this poem; instead, he carefully explains what true love is and what it is not. He begins by saying that nothing should stand in the way of the “marriage of true minds,” and then goes on to describe love as something that never changes. He uses thoughtful comparisons, like love being an “ever-fixed mark” or a guiding “star” to lost ships, to show that real love is steady and reliable. He also says that love is not affected by Time, even though time can take away beauty. The poem follows a logical structure, with each part exploring different aspects of love. In the end, the poet confidently concludes that his definition of love is the truth. Because the poem is thoughtful, structured, and focused on deep ideas rather than emotions, it is a perfect example of a meditative sonnet.

# **To India – My Native Land - Henry Louis Vivian Derozio**

## **A Note On The Poet :**

Henry Louis Vivian Derozio (1809-1831) was born in Calcutta and belonged to the Anglo-Indian community. He studied at the Dhurumtollah Academy founded by David Drummond, by whom he was greatly influenced. At the age of 17, he joined Hindu College as a teacher. He was known as a fiery teacher and poet. Derozio inspired a group of young people with the spirit of the Renaissance, who pioneered the Renaissance Movement in Bengal. He possessed a sense of patriotism for Bengal. He was a radical thinker and one of the first Indian educators to disseminate Western learning and science among students in Bengal. His teachings and progressive views on issues such as women's emancipation and widow remarriage were looked down upon by the conservative Hindus who managed Hindu College. As a result, he was dismissed from service. Derozio, however, kept up his struggle against Hindu orthodoxy. He died of cholera at the age of 22.

## **To India – My Native Land Summary :**

### **Introduction :**

"To India – My Native Land" is a patriotic sonnet written during the early 19th century, when India was under British rule. Henry Derozio, who is often considered the first Indian English poet, expresses his deep feelings of love, sorrow, and hope for India. The poem is filled with both nostalgia for India's glorious past and sadness over her present condition of slavery.

### **Lines 1-2:**

**"My country! In thy day of glory past  
A beauteous halo circled round thy brow,"**

The poet lovingly remembers India's past when she was glorious. India looked so magnificent that a beautiful halo (a shining circle of light) surrounded her forehead, symbolizing purity, divinity, and honor.

**Lines 3-4:**

**“And worshipped as a deity thou wast.  
Where is that glory, where that reverence now?”**

In the past, India was worshipped like a goddess.  
Now, the poet sadly asks where all that past glory and respect have gone — he feels India has lost her greatness.

**Lines 5-6:**

**“Thy eagle pinion is chained down at last,  
And grovelling in the lowly dust art thou;”**

India’s spirit, once as strong and free as an eagle’s wing (“pinion”), is now enslaved (“chained down”).  
Instead of flying high, India is lying low in the dust, humiliated under foreign (British) rule.

**Lines 7-8:**

**“Thy minstrel hath no wreath to weave for thee  
Save the sad story of thy misery!”**

The poet (calling himself India’s “minstrel,” or singer) says he has no beautiful songs (“wreaths”) to offer.  
He can only sing about India’s sadness and suffering.

**Lines 9-10:**

**“Well—let me dive into the depths of time,  
And bring from out the ages that have rolled”**

The poet says he will dive deep into the past (“depths of time”) and recover memories from history (“ages that have rolled” = time that has passed).

**Lines 11-12:**

**“A few small fragments of those wrecks sublime,  
Which human eyes may never more behold;”**

He hopes to gather a few pieces (“small fragments”) of India’s once-great achievements (“wrecks sublime” = remains of past glory), which people today can no longer see with their own eyes.

**Lines 13-14:**

**“And let the guerdon of my labour be  
My fallen country! One kind wish from thee!”**

The poet says that the only reward (“guerdon” = reward) he wants for his efforts is one kind wish or blessing from his fallen country (India).

He does not seek fame or riches — only India’s love and acknowledgment.

**Poetic Devices in the Poem:**

**1. Personification:** India is treated as a living being, suffering and in need of revival.

**2. Metaphor:**

“A beauteous halo” symbolizes India’s past glory.

“Eagle pinion is chained” symbolizes India’s loss of freedom.

**3. Alliteration:** “Groveling in the lowly dust” emphasizes India’s degradation.

**4. Imagery:** Vivid images of India’s past glory and present misery, like “eagle pinion chained.”

**5. Rhetorical Question:** “Where is that glory, where that reverence now?” expresses sorrow over India’s fall.

**6. Symbolism:** The “eagle” represents freedom; the “minstrel” symbolizes the poet’s role in preserving history.

**Themes in the Poem :**

**1. Patriotism:** The poet’s love for India and desire to restore her glory.

**2. Loss and Decline:** India’s fall from greatness under colonial rule.

**3. Hope and Revival:** Belief in India’s potential to rise again through remembering the past.

**4. Memory and History:** Emphasis on preserving India’s glorious past to inspire future generations.

**5. Suffering and Injustice:** The pain of India under British rule, symbolized by her fall and degradation.

### **Conclusion:**

In conclusion, “To India – My Native Land” is a poignant expression of Henry Derozio’s love, sorrow, and hope for India. The poem reflects on India’s glorious past, her current state of subjugation, and the poet’s desire to revive her lost dignity. Through vivid imagery and powerful emotions, Derozio calls for a restoration of national pride, urging his fellow countrymen to remember India’s greatness and work towards her future freedom.

## **I. Short Answer Questions:**

### **1. According to the poet, how was India treated in the past?**

- a. a worshipped as a god
  - b. chained as an eagle
  - c. glorified by minstrels
  - d. none of the above
- Ans: a. Worshipped as a god

### **2. Who is the poet referring to as a 'minstrel'?**

Ans: The poet refers to himself as a "minstrel." He uses this term to describe his role as a poet or singer who weaves the stories of India's past glory and present suffering.

### **3. The poet asks for \_\_\_\_\_ as a reward for his labour.**

Ans: The poet asks for "one kind wish from thee" as a reward for his labor, referring to India. He seeks the blessing or goodwill of his country in return for his poetic efforts.

### **4. What is the poet's wish?**

Ans: The poet's wish is to see India rise from her current state of misery and regain her lost glory. He wishes for India to be free from oppression and restored to her former greatness.

## **II. Answer the following questions in about one page each.**

### **1. How does the poet bring out the transformation in India's fortunes?**

Ans: In "To India – My Native Land," the poet, Henry Derozio, presents a striking contrast between India's glorious past and her current state of subjugation. He begins by recalling India's once-divine status, symbolized by the "beauteous halo" around her brow. In those days, India was revered and worshipped like a goddess. However, Derozio laments that India's former glory has disappeared, and the country is now "chained" and "grovelling in the lowly dust." This transformation from a respected nation to one under foreign rule symbolizes the tragic fall of India under British colonialism. Through vivid imagery, the poet captures India's lost freedom, using metaphors like "eagle pinion is chained" to represent the country's oppressed state. The poet wishes to restore India's lost greatness, emphasizing the deep transformation from respect to degradation.

**2. A sense of loss and sadness defines the tone of this poem. Discuss.**

Ans: The tone of the poem is deeply sorrowful and mournful, filled with a sense of loss. Derozio expresses his grief over the fall of India, once a land of glory, now reduced to suffering and oppression under British rule. The line “Where is that glory, where that reverence now?” highlights the poet’s lament over India’s lost dignity. He mourns not only the political decline but also the cultural and spiritual degradation of his country. Phrases like “grovelling in the lowly dust” and “Thy minstrel hath no wreath to weave for thee” further emphasize the sadness and helplessness the poet feels. The poem reflects a collective mourning for the lost heritage and the tragic state of the country, making the tone one of deep sorrow and regret.

**3. Why does the poet want to ‘dive into the depths of time’?**

Ans: The poet desires to “dive into the depths of time” to retrieve the fragments of India’s glorious past. Derozio wants to explore the rich history and traditions of India that have been lost or forgotten over time. By delving into the past, he hopes to bring back the memory of India’s greatness, which could inspire her people to revive their national pride and dignity. This act of recalling history is not only an emotional response to India’s current suffering but also a way to preserve the country’s cultural heritage for future generations. The poet’s wish is to remind India of her glorious legacy and to awaken a sense of pride and hope in her people.

**4. Discuss ‘To India-My Native Land’ as Derozio’s tribute to India.**

Ans: “To India – My Native Land” can be seen as Derozio’s heartfelt tribute to India, where he expresses his deep love, sorrow, and hope for the nation. Through the poem, Derozio acknowledges India’s former greatness and mourns her current state of subjugation under British rule. His tribute is not just one of lamentation but also a call for revival. By remembering the glorious past and reawakening the nation’s pride, he aims to inspire his fellow Indians to strive for freedom and dignity. The poet uses powerful metaphors, such as the “eagle pinion” and “grovelling in the lowly dust,” to depict the fall of India, while also highlighting the potential for restoration. In this sense, the poem becomes both a tribute to India’s past and a hopeful plea for her future. Through his poetry, Derozio offers a lasting tribute to the country’s rich heritage, encouraging a nationalistic spirit and a desire for independence.

**III. Answer the following questions in about two pages each.**

**1. “Thy eagle pinion is chained down at last, / And grovelling in the lowly dust art thou.” – Explain the meaning of the given lines. What comparison does the poet make in these lines? Why?**

Ans: In these lines, Derozio uses powerful imagery to convey India's fall from grace. The phrase "Thy eagle pinion is chained down at last" represents India's loss of freedom and strength. The "eagle pinion" (eagle's wing) symbolizes the power, pride, and independence of the country. Eagles are known for their strength and freedom, soaring high in the sky, but in the poem, the eagle's wings are "chained," indicating that India's freedom has been restricted. The metaphor here compares India's once-independent state to the eagle, emphasizing the country's loss of sovereignty under British colonial rule.

The second line, "And grovelling in the lowly dust art thou," intensifies the image of India's degradation. "Grovelling" suggests that India is now in a position of extreme humility, crawling in the dust like a defeated and oppressed entity. This "lowly dust" symbolizes the suffering, humiliation, and oppression that India is enduring. The comparison is drawn between India as a once-proud and free nation and her current state of submission and weakness under colonialism.

The poet uses this comparison to highlight the tragic transformation of India. Once a land of glory, respected by the world, India is now reduced to a state of subjugation. Through the imagery of the eagle's chained wings and the country "grovelling" in dust, Derozio mourns India's fall and calls attention to the oppression and loss of freedom. The comparison of India to an eagle, a symbol of strength, helps to emphasize the contrast between her former grandeur and her present misery, urging the reader to reflect on the loss of national pride and freedom.

## **2. Would you consider this a patriotic poem? Give reasons for your answer.**

Ans: Yes, "To India – My Native Land" can be considered a patriotic poem, and there are several reasons for this.

First and foremost, the poem expresses a deep love and affection for India, which is the essence of patriotism. Derozio refers to India as "My country!" at the very beginning, emphasizing his personal connection and loyalty to the land. This emotional bond is one of the key indicators of patriotism, as the poet is not merely lamenting the country's fall but also mourning the loss of something precious that belongs to him and to all Indians.

Furthermore, the poem is a call for national revival and a critique of the country's current state under colonial rule. The poet uses vivid and painful imagery, like "grovelling in the lowly dust," to highlight India's degradation under British oppression. However, despite this sorrow, there is an underlying call to action and a desire for change, which is rooted in patriotism. Derozio wishes for India's rebirth and restoration, as shown by the line: "And let the guerdon of my labour be / My fallen country! One kind wish from thee!" This

illustrates the poet's hope for India's recovery and suggests that his labor (through writing) will lead to the nation's revival, which is a patriotic act of serving one's country.

The very structure of the poem reinforces a nationalistic sentiment. Derozio refers to India's past glory, using terms like "worshipped as a deity," to evoke a sense of national pride and to remind Indians of their rich heritage. By doing so, he stirs a sense of unity and national identity, urging his fellow countrymen to take pride in their history and work towards reclaiming that glory. The poem is not merely a lament; it's also an expression of the poet's belief in India's potential to rise again.

Moreover, Derozio's desire to "dive into the depths of time" and bring back fragments of India's glorious past is another example of his patriotism. He is not just reflecting on history for the sake of nostalgia; he is drawing on the past to inspire India's future. The poet's intent is to awaken his fellow Indians to the realization of their nation's potential, motivating them to aspire toward freedom and greatness once more.

In conclusion, "To India – My Native Land" is undoubtedly a patriotic poem because it reflects the poet's deep love for his country, his sorrow over its present condition, and his hope for its revival. Derozio's words encourage Indians to remember their heritage and take pride in it, as well as to work towards a brighter, independent future. The poem is a call to action, urging the reader to reclaim national pride and sovereignty, which are key aspects of patriotism.

# A Service of Love - O. Henry

## A Note On The Writer:

O. Henry, born William Sydney Porter on September 11, 1862, was an American short story writer known for his clever plots, witty dialogue, and surprise endings. He worked in various jobs, including as a bank clerk, but was convicted of embezzlement and sent to prison. It was during his imprisonment that he began to focus on writing.

O. Henry is credited with over 600 short stories, many set in New York City, and often revolving around themes of love, irony, and unexpected twists. His works are filled with warmth and humor, portraying the lives of ordinary people. Some of his most famous stories include The Gift of the Magi, The Ransom of Red Chief, and The Cop and the Anthem.

## A Service of Love Summary :

### Introduction :

This story is essentially identical to O. Henry's more famous story 'The Gift of the Magi'. Both stories are based on the theme of love and portray the things that people do out of love. Joe and Delia love each other very much. Each of them is really passionate about their respective forms of art, and want to be successful in it. However, their love for each other exceeds their love for art.

**Setting:** The story takes place in New York City, a place where many young artists and musicians come to chase their dreams.

### Characters:

**Joe Larrabee:** A young man who dreams of becoming a famous artist.

**Delia Carruthers:** A young woman who aspires to be a renowned pianist.

**Miss Elsie Marsh:** A fictional character Delia invents.

## Plot Explanation:

Joe and Delia are passionately in love. They meet in an art studio and quickly realize that they share the same goal to achieve greatness in their respective arts. They marry and decide to live together in a small apartment, believing that their love will help them overcome poverty and hardship.

In the beginning, everything is full of hope. Joe continues painting, and Delia starts giving music lessons to support them financially. They have very little money, but they are optimistic and believe that success will come soon.

However, life in New York is harsh. Finding good-paying students is difficult, and Delia's number of pupils decreases. Yet, she tells Joe that she has found a wealthy student named Miss Elsie Marsh, who pays her \$15 a lesson a huge amount for them. Delia's supposed success makes Joe proud and happy.

Secretly, though, Delia is not giving music lessons anymore. When she realized that her music teaching career was failing, she chose to work at a laundry, ironing clothes, to earn money. She hides this from Joe because she does not want to hurt his pride or make him feel like a burden. She believes her sacrifice is a service of love.

Meanwhile, Joe, too, notices their worsening financial condition. Although he tries to paint and sell his work, he finds no buyers. Eventually, Joe secretly gives up painting and takes a job selling hats in a department store, pretending that he is still focused on his art. He does not tell Delia because he wants her to feel free to follow her dream without worrying about money.

One evening, Joe notices Delia coming home tired and her hands burned slightly not the hands of a piano teacher. Suspecting something, he follows her the next day and sees her entering a laundry. Joe realizes the truth: Delia has been working there to support them, not giving music lessons.

When they meet that night, Joe lovingly confronts her. Delia confesses everything and is worried that Joe would be angry or ashamed. But Joe smiles and reveals that he, too, has been sacrificing he had stopped painting and was working in a department store.

Both laugh through their tears, realizing how much they love each other. Each had secretly given up their own dreams to support the other's dream. Their sacrifices show

the true meaning of love: selflessness, devotion, and the willingness to put someone else's happiness above their own.

### **Themes in the story:**

**1.Selfless Love:** True love means sacrifice without expecting anything in return.

**2.Dreams vs. Reality:** Sometimes, harsh realities force people to make difficult choices.

**3.Irony:** Both Joe and Delia thought they were helping the other by sacrificing secretly, but both were sacrificing their own dreams.

**4.Pride and Honesty:** They both lied, but their lies came from a place of deep love and pride in each other.

## **I. Short Answer Questions.**

### **1. What was Joe Larrabee's first successful work of art?**

Ans: Joe Larrabee's first successful work of art was a picture of the head of a nymph done in red chalk.

### **2. Who helped Delia Caruthers go to New York to study music?**

Ans: An old music teacher in her Southern hometown helped Delia Caruthers by raising enough money to send her to New York to study music.

### **3. What is the author's advice to 'the rich young man'?**

Ans: The author advises the rich young man to get an artistic job such as selling sandwiches instead of trying to become a great artist, suggesting that art is not a secure way to earn a living.

### **4. Joe and Delia met in a .....**

- a. studio
- b. drugstore
- c. restaurant
- d. relative's house

Ans: (a) studio.

### **5. When faced with hard times, the couple believed that when one loves one's Art no ..... seems too hard.**

Ans: service.

### **6. 'Oh, I really am getting very fond of her, she is so gentle and noble.' Who is Delia referring to?**

Ans: Delia is referring to her imaginary pupil, Miss Elsie Marsh.

### **7. Who was the rich buyer of Joe's paintings? What kind of paintings did he buy?**

Ans: The rich buyer of Joe's paintings was a man who bought landscape paintings to use them as backgrounds for showcasing hats in a department store.

### **8. What reason did Delia give for her hand getting burnt?**

Ans: Delia said that she accidentally burnt her hand while lighting the lamp in her music pupil's home.

### **9. Did Joe believe Delia's story about getting her hand burnt?**

Ans: No, Joe did not fully believe Delia's story. He suspected that something was wrong when he saw her burnt hand and eventually followed her to find out the truth.

**10. What confession does Joe make to his wife?**

Ans: Joe confesses to Delia that he had stopped painting and had been working in a department store selling hats to earn money.

**II. Answer the following questions in about one pages each.**

**1. Describe the home life of the Larrabee's in the small flat.**

Ans: Joe and Delia Larrabee lived a simple and modest life in a small flat in New York. Their home was not luxurious, but it was filled with love and dreams. They decorated it as best as they could with their limited means, and their days were filled with hope, hard work, and artistic ambition. Despite the poverty, they were happy because they believed in each other's talent and future success. They faced hardships with optimism, believing that their love and passion for art would help them overcome any obstacle.

**2. What are Joe and Delia's ambitions? Do they reach their goal?**

Ans: Joe aspired to become a great artist, while Delia dreamed of becoming a famous pianist. They moved to New York with these goals in mind. However, they did not immediately achieve their dreams. Instead, they faced the harsh reality that art alone could not provide them with a living. Both secretly gave up their dreams temporarily to support each other by taking regular jobs. Though they did not reach their artistic goals at the time, they succeeded in building a relationship based on true love, sacrifice, and understanding.

**3. How does Delia describe her pupil?**

Ans: Delia describes her imaginary pupil, Miss Elsie Marsh, as gentle, noble, and musically talented. She says that Miss Marsh is very fond of music and is willing to pay well for her lessons. Delia praises her pupil's good nature, creating an image of a perfect student to make Joe feel happy and proud, even though the pupil does not exist.

**4. What do their respective lies tell us about Joe and Delia?**

Ans: Joe and Delia's lies reveal their deep love, selflessness, and willingness to sacrifice their own dreams for each other's happiness. They both lied not out of selfishness, but to protect and support each other. Their actions show that true love involves sacrifice, caring more for the well-being of the loved one than for oneself. Their lies were a form of "service of love," highlighting the strength of their bond and their readiness to face hardship for each other.

**5. 'When one loves one's art, no service seems too hard' is the happy viewpoint of art student Joe and music student Delia. But the two learn the truth about love, life and sacrifice. Discuss.**

Ans: At the beginning of the story, Joe and Delia believe that their love for art will make every hardship easy to bear. They are idealistic, thinking that passion alone is enough to succeed. However, as time passes, they realize that love for art is not enough to meet basic needs. Real life demands sacrifices, and dreams must sometimes be set aside. Their discovery that they had both secretly given up their art to support each other shows a deeper truth: love for each other was stronger than love for art. Through their sacrifices, they learn that true love often means putting another person's happiness and well-being before personal ambition.

**6. Discuss the theme of 'A Service of Love'.**

Ans: The main theme of "A Service of Love" is selfless sacrifice made out of love. Joe and Delia both give up their artistic dreams to financially support each other without the other knowing. Their secret sacrifices reveal the true depth of their love. Another important theme is the difference between dreams and reality while they both had high hopes, real-life struggles forced them to choose survival over ambition. O. Henry also explores irony, as both characters make the same kind of sacrifice without realizing it. The story ultimately celebrates the idea that love is not about grand gestures, but about small, difficult sacrifices made with a willing heart.

**III. Answer the following questions in about two pages each.**

**1. 'But after a while Art became weak.' What difficulties do Joe and Delia face?**

Ans: At first, Joe and Delia are full of excitement and hope. They passionately pursue their dreams: Joe wants to become a great artist, and Delia dreams of being a famous pianist. However, after some time, they face financial hardships. Their small earnings from art and music are not enough to cover their daily living expenses like food, rent, and bills.

As the pressure to survive grows, their love for Art weakens compared to the need for money. They realize that New York City is a tough place where dreams alone cannot fill an empty stomach. Joe struggles to sell his paintings, and Delia finds it difficult to get well-paying pupils.

Out of love for each other, they secretly take up regular jobs. Joe starts selling hats at a department store, while Delia does ironing work for a theatre company. They both hide the truth from each other to protect each other's feelings.

Thus, the difficulties Joe and Delia face are mainly poverty, the harsh reality of survival, and the conflict between dreams and responsibilities. These difficulties show how challenging it is to follow one's passion when faced with life's practical needs.

**2. O. Henry always leaves us wondering what the story is all about until the end. Comment with reference to the story.**

Ans: O. Henry is famous for his surprise endings and clever storytelling style, and "A Service of Love" is no exception. Throughout the story, the reader is led to believe that Joe and Delia are doing well in their artistic careers. They both tell each other cheerful stories about their successes: Joe talks about selling his paintings to a rich man, and Delia proudly mentions teaching music to a gentle young girl named Elsie Marsh.

However, O. Henry hides the truth from the reader until the very end. Only when Joe accidentally burns his hand and Delia becomes emotional do they both confess: neither was working in art. Joe was selling hats, and Delia was doing ironing work.

This twist reveals that their 'services of love' were not artistic triumphs but sacrifices they made out of deep love for each other. The real meaning of the story is uncovered only at the end, making the reader rethink everything that happened earlier. O. Henry uses irony and surprise to deliver the message that love and sacrifice are greater than personal ambition.

Thus, O. Henry keeps the true meaning hidden until the final confession, leaving the reader surprised and touched by the strength of Joe and Delia's love.

**3. How do Joe and Delia account for their earnings? What is the truth?**

Ans: Joe and Delia both create false stories to explain how they are earning money. Delia tells Joe that she has a rich pupil, Miss Elsie Marsh, who is paying her handsomely for piano lessons. She pretends that her pupil is a sweet and noble girl who values Delia's music teaching.

Similarly, Joe tells Delia that a wealthy man has bought several of his paintings. He says that the man wanted the paintings to decorate his new house, which makes Delia believe that Joe is finally becoming successful.

The truth, however, is very different.

Joe has not sold any paintings. Instead, he works at a department store, selling ladies' hats. Delia has no music pupil either. She works in a theatre laundry, ironing clothes for stage actors. Both Joe and Delia take on these jobs secretly because they do not want the other person to feel disappointed.

Their lies are acts of love and sacrifice. They each pretend to be succeeding in their artistic dreams so that the other person remains hopeful and happy. In reality, their earnings come from hard, ordinary jobs not from art or music.

**4. Delia changes her motto from 'When one loves one's Art, no service seems too hard,' to 'When one loves.' Why do you think she does this?**

Ans: At the beginning of the story, Delia believes that passion for art can overcome any hardship. She and Joe proudly say, "When one loves one's Art, no service seems too hard." They think their love for their creative work will make sacrifices easy.

However, as the story progresses, Delia realizes that love for a person is even greater than love for art. She sacrifices her dream of being a musician to work in a laundry so that Joe can continue painting without worrying about money. When she sees Joe's burnt hand and realizes he has also been making sacrifices, she understands that real love is not about selfish dreams but about caring for each other.

Thus, Delia changes her motto to simply "When one loves." She understands that true love not ambition, not pride, not dreams is what truly matters. Love for another person gives the strength to face any hardship without regret.

This change shows Delia's growth from being an idealistic art student to a mature, loving wife, ready to sacrifice her own dreams for someone she loves deeply.

# The Monkey's Paw - William Wymark Jacobs

## A Note On The Writer :

William Wymark Jacobs (1863-1943) had a quaint and peculiar humour in his writing, and he became quite famous for his humorous stories and novels, mostly about seafaring men. Jacobs is remembered for a macabre tale, 'The Monkey's Paw', published in 1902 in a short-story collection titled *The Lady of the Barge*. He wrote several other ghost stories, including 'The Toll House' (from *Sailors' Knots*) and 'Jerry Bundler' (in *Light Freights*). Other collections of short stories by Jacobs include *Many Cargoes*, *The Skipper's Wooing*, *A Master of Craft* and *Night Watches*.

## The Monkey's Paw Summary :

**Setting:** The story is set in England, mostly inside the small, cozy home of the White family. It is a cold, rainy night, which helps create a gloomy and tense atmosphere right from the beginning.

### Characters:

**Mr. White:** An ordinary man, curious but reckless. His choices drive the tragedy.

**Mrs. White:** A loving mother, later driven to desperation by grief.

**Herbert White:** Their cheerful and witty son, who becomes a victim of the paw's magic.

**Sergeant-Major Morris:** A family friend who warns them about the monkey's paw, having experienced its curse firsthand.

### Plot Summary:

#### Beginning:

The White family is relaxing at home when Sergeant-Major Morris arrives. Over dinner, he talks about his adventures in India and introduces them to a strange artifact — a mummified monkey's paw. He explains that a fakir (a holy man) cursed the paw to prove

that fate controls people's lives, and those who interfere with it do so to their sorrow. The paw can grant three wishes, but the results come with great misfortune.

Morris, clearly disturbed by the paw's power, throws it into the fire, but Mr. White saves it. Morris warns them again and leaves. Curious and tempted, Mr. White wishes for £200 to clear their house debt.

### **Middle:**

At first, nothing happens, and they laugh off the wish. However, the next day, a man from Herbert's workplace arrives at their home, nervously delivering tragic news: Herbert has been killed in a horrific accident at the factory. As compensation, the company offers £200 exactly the amount Mr. White wished for.

The White family is devastated. Mr. and Mrs. White realize that the monkey's paw caused their son's death to fulfill the wish. Grief fills their lives, turning their home cold and lifeless.

### **Climax:**

About a week later, still heartbroken, Mrs. White demands that Mr. White use the second wish to bring Herbert back to life. Mr. White hesitates but eventually gives in to her desperation. After he makes the wish, a chilling, eerie knock sounds at the door.

Mrs. White, thrilled and hopeful, rushes to open the door, believing her son has returned. Mr. White, however, is terrified. He fears that Herbert might not have returned whole, remembering the terrible injuries Herbert suffered. In panic, he grabs the paw and makes the third and final wish.

### **Ending:**

When Mrs. White finally manages to open the door, no one is there. Whatever Mr. White wished for likely that Herbert should return to the grave has been fulfilled. The story ends in haunting silence, leaving the reader to reflect on the tragic consequences of tampering with fate.

## **Themes in the Story:**

**1.Fate vs. Free Will:** The story warns that humans should not try to control fate.

**2.The Danger of Greed and Desire:** Wanting more than what life naturally offers leads to destruction.

**3.The Supernatural:** The monkey's paw symbolizes unknown, uncontrollable forces.

**4.Loss and Grief:** The Whites' deep sorrow shows how powerful and blinding grief can be.

### **Moral of the Story:**

The story teaches that messing with fate and wishing for more than what life naturally gives can have terrible consequences. Be careful what you wish for, because every desire may have a hidden price.

## **I. Short Answer Questions**

### **1. Why did Mr. White have a 'guilty grin'?**

Ans: Mr. White had a guilty grin because he made a mistake while playing chess with his son Herbert, which led to his defeat. He felt slightly embarrassed about his poor move.

### **2. What stories did Sergeant-Major Morris share with the White family?**

Ans: Sergeant-Major Morris shared stories about his adventurous life in India, including strange and mysterious happenings. He also spoke about the monkey's paw and its magical but dangerous power to grant three wishes.

### **3. 'I'd like to go to ..... myself,' said Mr. White.**

Ans: "I'd like to go to India myself," said Mr. White.

### **4. What was special about the monkey's paw, according to Sergeant-Major Morris?**

Ans: According to Sergeant-Major Morris, the monkey's paw had the magical power to grant three wishes to three different people, but each wish came with a heavy price and led to misfortune.

### **5. Why did the fakir put a spell on the monkey's paw?**

- a. to make his wishes come true
- b. to show that fate ruled people's lives
- c. to use it to curse anyone who touched it
- d. to unlock a treasure chest with it

Ans: (b) to show that fate ruled people's lives.

### **6. Mr. White's first wish was for .....**

- a. two hundred
- b. a palace
- c. a treasure
- d. three hundred pounds

Ans: (a) two hundred pounds.

### **7. What news did the man from Maw and Meggins bring?**

Ans: The man from Maw and Meggins brought the tragic news that Herbert had died in an accident at the factory. As compensation, the company offered £200 to Mr and Mrs White.

**8. 'It is foolish and wicked.' What is Mr White referring to?**

Ans: Mr. White is referring to the idea of wishing on the monkey's paw again, especially after seeing the tragic result of the first wish.

**9. Why did Mr White frantically look for the paw when he heard the knock on the door?**

Ans: Mr. White frantically looked for the paw because he was terrified that Herbert, in his mutilated state, had returned from the grave. He wanted to use the paw to undo his second wish.

**10. Mr. White's last and third wish was to .....**

Ans: Mr. White's last and third wish was to reverse the second wish he wished for Herbert to return to the grave, so that the horror outside the door would disappear.

**II. Answer the following questions in about one page each**

**1. Comment on the significance of Mrs White's line: 'How could two hundred pounds hurt you, eh, Father?'**

Ans: Mrs. White's line, "How could two hundred pounds hurt you, eh, Father?" is deeply ironic. At the time, she says it playfully, suggesting that wishing for money could cause no harm. However, the events that follow prove the opposite. The money comes to them only through the death of their son, Herbert. This line highlights the central theme of the story that interfering with fate can have terrible consequences. It also shows how people often underestimate the dangers of getting what they wish for without considering the price attached to it. Mrs White's innocent remark foreshadows the tragedy that is about to unfold.

**2. Explain the power of the monkey's paw.**

Ans: The monkey's paw holds a supernatural power: it can grant three wishes to three different owners. However, its magic is cursed. Each wish granted by the paw comes true, but in a twisted and tragic way, teaching that fate cannot be changed without suffering. The fakir who enchanted the paw did so to show that humans should not meddle with destiny. The White family's experience proves the power of the paw Mr. White's wish for money leads to Herbert's death; their wish for Herbert's return brings horror instead of happiness. The paw symbolizes the dangers of greed and the punishment for those who try to alter the natural order of life.

### **3. Describe the character of Herbert.**

Ans: Herbert White is portrayed as a cheerful, witty, and loving son. He is playful and jokes about the monkey's paw, calling it silly. Despite his teasing nature, Herbert is hardworking and devoted to his parents. His easy-going attitude brings lightness to the family's life. Sadly, Herbert becomes the innocent victim of his father's wish. After his death, the story takes a dark and tragic turn. Herbert's character also symbolizes innocence lost due to the reckless actions of others. His playful jokes about the paw before his death make his tragic end even more heartbreaking.

### **4. Trace Mrs White's attitude towards the monkey's paw as the story progresses.**

Ans: At the beginning, Mrs White treats the monkey's paw lightly, almost as a joke. She does not believe in its powers and even laughs when Mr. White makes the first wish. After Herbert's death, her attitude changes drastically. Grief-stricken and desperate to get her son back, she becomes obsessed with the paw. She forces Mr. White to use the second wish to bring Herbert back to life. Mrs White's transformation shows how grief can overpower reason and drive a person to ignore warnings and danger. Her journey from laughter to desperation reflects the emotional depth and horror that the paw's magic brings into their lives.

## **III. Answer the following questions in about two pages each.**

### **1. Describe how the author is able to create an atmosphere of horror in the story. Support your answer with examples from the text.**

Ans: W.W. Jacobs creates an atmosphere of horror in *The Monkey's Paw* through a careful use of setting, foreshadowing, and suspense. From the very beginning, the story is set on a cold and rainy night. The isolated location of the White family's home adds to the eerie feeling. The arrival of Sergeant-Major Morris brings tension. His serious warnings about the paw's magic, his refusal to talk about his experiences, and his fearful behavior hint that something terrible will happen.

Jacobs uses foreshadowing skillfully. When Morris says the paw brings sorrow to those who use it, the readers feel a sense of dread. Even Herbert's joking tone makes readers uneasy, especially when he says he might never see the money they wished for. After Herbert's death, the mood becomes darker. The knocking on the door after the second wish builds suspense to a peak. The slow, increasing intensity of the knocks terrifies Mr. and Mrs. White and the readers alike.

The horror also comes from the unseen we never see Herbert after his death, but the idea of his mutilated body returning home is far more frightening. Jacobs keeps the

readers' imagination active, making the horror psychological. The unknown becomes scarier than anything shown directly.

Thus, the author masterfully creates horror using mood, foreshadowing, and suspenseful events throughout the story.

## **2. Examine the theme of desire in the story.**

Ans: Desire is one of the main themes of The Monkey's Paw. The story shows how strong desires, even innocent ones, can lead to tragic consequences. Mr. and Mrs. White desire a better life and financial comfort, which makes them wish for £200. However, the wish comes true in a horrible way when they receive the money only after their son's death.

The theme also appears in Mrs. White's desperate wish to bring Herbert back to life. Her strong desire blinds her to the possible consequences. She is so grief-stricken that she forces Mr. White to use the second wish. Her emotions overpower logic and fear. Mr. White, though more cautious, still gives in to his wife's desire.

The story teaches that desire can be dangerous when it tries to change fate. The White family's wishes, meant to improve their lives, instead destroy them. Their experience shows that desires, if unchecked, can lead to sorrow and horror.

In the end, The Monkey's Paw warns readers that desiring more than what fate has given can bring devastating results, and sometimes, it is better to accept life as it is.

## **3. 'Money is the root of all evil.' Discuss this idea in the light of the story.**

Ans: The saying "Money is the root of all evil" fits The Monkey's Paw perfectly. The White family's first wish is for £200, a simple desire for financial security. However, this innocent wish sets off a chain of tragic events. Herbert dies in a factory accident, and the company gives them £200 as compensation. The money comes, but at a terrible cost the life of their only son.

The story shows that greed and longing for wealth can have unexpected and devastating consequences. Mr. White wishes for money without thinking of how it might be granted. The fact that their wish leads to death suggests that money, or the desire for it, can corrupt even good people and destroy happiness.

Moreover, after getting the money, the family is left broken and miserable. Their wealth cannot bring back what they have lost. This highlights the emptiness of material wealth when compared to love, family, and life itself.

Through the White family's tragic experience, Jacobs suggests that greed and desire for money are dangerous and that one should be careful about what they wish for.

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# Black Money and the Black Economy

■ C. Rammanohar Reddy

## A Note On The Writer :

C. Rammanohar Reddy is an Indian writer and journalist known for his clear and thoughtful writings on social, political, and economic issues. He served as the Editor of the Economic and Political Weekly (EPW), one of India's most respected academic journals, from 2004 to 2016. His work often focuses on topics like democracy, public policy, rural development, and financial systems. Apart from journalism, he has edited and contributed to several important books and articles, aiming to make complex ideas accessible to the common reader. His balanced and factual style of writing has earned him great respect among readers and scholars alike.

## Black Money and the Black Economy Summary :

### Introduction: What is Black Money?

C. Rammanohar Reddy begins by explaining that black money is any income that is not declared to the government to escape taxes. It is not just money earned from illegal activities like crime; it can also come from legal businesses that hide their earnings. The hidden money is called "black" because it is outside the formal economy and not recorded officially.

He points out that black money is a part of the larger black economy, which refers to all economic activities that are unregulated, untaxed, and unreported.

### How is Black Money Generated?

**Reddy identifies many ways through which black money is generated:**

Under-reporting income by businesses and individuals (example: a shopkeeper shows less sales to pay less tax).

Bribes and corruption in government offices and private companies.

Over-invoicing or under-invoicing in trade (example: showing fake prices in imports and exports to transfer money abroad).

Real estate deals where the buyer and seller exchange a large portion of money in cash without receipts.

Education and healthcare sectors, where large donations or fees are accepted unofficially.

Political funding, where large sums are spent during elections without proper records.

Thus, black money flows in almost every sector of Indian society.

## **Effects of Black Money on the Economy**

### **Reddy explains that black money has several negative effects:**

**Loss of government revenue:** When people hide income, the government collects less tax, leading to lower spending on public services like education, health, and infrastructure.

**Economic inequality:** Rich people hide wealth, and poor people suffer more. This creates a gap between the rich and the poor.

**Corruption and moral decay:** Widespread black money leads to a culture of dishonesty and distrust in public institutions.

**Impact on democracy:** Huge amounts of black money are used in elections to buy votes, which corrupts the democratic process.

**Distortion of economy:** Black money is often invested in assets like gold and real estate rather than productive industries, which harms economic growth.

## **Size of the Black Economy**

Although it is difficult to measure the exact size of the black economy, estimates suggest that it could be more than 20% of India's total GDP.

This means that a huge portion of India's economy operates outside legal and tax systems.

## **The Case of Demonetisation (2016)**

The essay discusses demonetisation, a major step taken by the Indian government in November 2016, when ₹500 and ₹1000 notes were banned overnight.

### **The objective of demonetisation was to:**

Target black money held in cash.  
Reduce corruption and fake currency.  
Push India towards a cashless economy.

However, Reddy argues that demonetisation failed in controlling black money:

Most black wealth is not kept in cash but invested in property, gold, and foreign banks.

Nearly 99% of the banned notes returned to the banking system, showing that very little black cash was destroyed.

It caused hardships to ordinary people, especially the poor, who depend heavily on cash transactions.

Thus, demonetisation was a short-term, partial solution and did not address the real roots of the black economy.

## **Solutions Suggested by the Author**

**Reddy stresses that sustainable solutions are needed to tackle black money:**

**1. Tax Reforms:** Simplify the tax system, lower tax rates, and make paying taxes easier and more attractive.

**2. Political Reforms:** Clean up election funding by ensuring transparency in political donations and spending.

**3. Strengthening Institutions:** Make agencies like the Income Tax Department, Enforcement Directorate, and Judiciary stronger, independent, and free from political interference.

**4. Public Awareness:** Encourage citizens to demand honesty and transparency and create a culture where paying taxes and reporting income is seen as normal and respected.

**5. Global Cooperation:** Work with other countries to crack down on Indian money illegally held abroad (in Swiss banks and tax havens).

## **Conclusion :**

C. Rammanohar Reddy concludes by saying that fighting black money is a long-term process. It cannot be solved through sudden moves like demonetization alone. What is needed is consistent effort, strong political will, reforms in governance, and public participation to build an honest and transparent economy.

## **I. Short Answer Questions.**

### **1. Why does the relative importance of each kind of black money vary from one society to another?**

Ans: The relative importance of each kind of black money varies from one society to another because different societies have different political systems, economic structures, legal frameworks, and cultural values. For example, in some societies, political corruption may be the main source of black money, while in others, tax evasion by businesses might be more dominant.

### **2. Name the different kinds of assets in which illegal money is usually held.**

Ans: Illegal money is usually held in the form of cash, gold, real estate, shares and securities, foreign currency, offshore bank accounts, and investments in businesses. These assets help hide the true ownership and origin of the money.

### **3. According to the author, if black money is to be removed from the economy, it is the ..... which must be destroyed.**

Ans: black economy

### **4. How does black money move across national borders?**

Ans: Black money moves across national borders through methods like transfer pricing in international trade, hawala networks, over-invoicing and under-invoicing of exports and imports, money laundering via banks and shell companies, and by depositing money in tax havens and offshore financial centers.

### **5. The following is not a way in which black money is generated:**

- a. transfer pricing in trade
- b. money laundering through trade
- c. buying products using cheques
- d. use of tax havens/offshore financial centres

Ans: c. buying products using cheques

## **II. Answer the following questions in about one page each.**

### **1. Briefly explain what the 'black and white streams' are in an economy.**

Ans: In an economy, the 'white stream' refers to all legal and declared economic activities those that are properly recorded, taxed, and monitored by the government. This includes legitimate income, investments, and transactions.

The 'black stream' refers to all illegal or undeclared economic activities. This stream consists of earnings that are not reported to the authorities to avoid paying taxes or to hide the illegal nature of the activity. It includes income from bribes, tax evasion, smuggling, illegal businesses, and unaccounted wealth.

According to the author, in reality, the black and white streams are closely connected. Money can move easily between them. For instance, black money can be converted into white money through laundering, and white money can turn black if not properly reported. Thus, separating the two streams is very difficult in practice.

## **2. What does the word 'benami' mean in tax-related usage?**

Ans: In tax-related usage, the word 'benami' means something held in the name of another person to hide the real ownership.

For example, a person may buy a property but register it under the name of a friend, relative, or an employee to avoid paying taxes or to conceal black money.

Benami transactions are used to hide illegal wealth and make it difficult for authorities to trace the real owner. To control this practice, the government has passed laws like the Benami Transactions (Prohibition) Act in India.

## **3. According to the author, what must be done in order to remove black money from the economy?**

Ans: According to the author, to remove black money from the economy, the black economy itself must be destroyed. Short-term actions like demonetisation are not enough.

The following steps must be taken:

Tax reforms to make the system simpler and fairer, encouraging people to pay taxes.

Political reforms to control black money used in election funding.

Institutional strengthening to ensure that tax authorities, enforcement agencies, and courts act independently and effectively.

Public awareness and cultural change to promote honesty and discourage the glorification of black money.

International cooperation to tackle money hidden in foreign banks and tax havens.

Only a consistent and long-term strategy can effectively reduce black money in the economy.

**4. According to the White Paper, what are the 'sectors' that are more vulnerable to the generation of black money?**

Ans: According to the White Paper on black money (2012) issued by the Government of India, the sectors that are more vulnerable to the generation of black money include:

Real estate sector

Mining

Pharmaceuticals and drugs

Education and health sectors (especially private institutions)

Public procurement (government contracts)

Financial markets (such as share trading without proper records)

Non-profit organizations (sometimes used for money laundering)

These sectors are vulnerable because they involve large amounts of unaccounted transactions, cash dealings, and lack strict regulatory oversight.

**III. Answer the following questions in about two page each.**

**1. What is 'black money' and how is it produced?**

Ans: Black money refers to money that is earned through illegal means or earned legally but not declared for tax purposes. It is called 'black' because it is hidden from the authorities, mainly to avoid paying taxes or because it comes from activities that are illegal (like corruption, smuggling, or crime).

**Black money is produced in many ways, such as:**

**1. Under-reporting income:** Businesses and individuals do not report their full income to evade taxes.

**2. Bribes and corruption:** Government officials and politicians accept bribes and hide that income.

**3. Over-invoicing and under-invoicing:** In international trade, goods are priced incorrectly to transfer money illegally.

**4. Benami transactions:** People buy assets like land or gold under someone else's name to hide real ownership.

**5. Use of tax havens:** Money is secretly sent to foreign countries where taxes are low or non-existent.

**6. Money laundering:** Illegal money is made to look legal by passing it through several transactions.

Thus, black money damages the economy by reducing government income (taxes) and increasing inequality between the rich and poor.

## **2. What is the 'black economy'?**

Ans: The black economy refers to the total amount of economic activity that is not reported to the government and remains hidden. It includes all the production, trade, and services that generate black money.

### **In the black economy:**

Goods and services are produced and sold without proper records.

No taxes are paid on the income earned.

Both individuals and companies participate knowingly.

According to C. Rammanohar Reddy, the black economy is not separate from the legal economy the two are closely linked. Black money flows into the white economy and vice versa. For example, black money may be invested in real estate, and profits from legal businesses may be hidden to become black money.

### **The black economy weakens the official economy by:**

Reducing tax revenue for public services.

Encouraging corruption and criminal activities.

Creating unfair competition for honest businesses.

Thus, to remove black money, it is important to destroy the black economy itself, not just attack individual acts of corruption.

# **The Chronicle of Hariya Dom - Shyamal Kumar Pramanik**

## **A Note On The Writer :**

Shyamal Kumar Pramanik was born in Nila village of South 24 Parganas in West Bengal. He has published collections of poems, novels and short stories as well as research articles in history. One of the prominent voices in contemporary Bangla Dalit writing, he was awarded the Ananya Nandanik Sahitya Puroshkar in 2000 and the Shaktikumar Sarkar Smriti Puroshkar in 2006.

This story has been translated by Srishti Dutta Chowdhury, who is a PhD student enrolled at Purdue University.

## **The Chronicle of Hariya Dom Summary :**

In a small, dusty village of India, lived a man named Hariya Dom. He belonged to the Dom caste, the so-called "untouchables," whose fate was written even before their birth. Hariya's job was one nobody else wanted he had to cremate dead bodies.

You would think a man who helped souls on their final journey would be respected. But no. Hariya was treated like dirt. People spat at him, abused him, and kept their distance. Even his shadow was seen as impure. Yet, when someone died, these same people would run to him. They needed Hariya to perform the last rites, to burn the body properly so the soul could find peace. How strange was this hypocrisy! They needed him but they could never respect him.

Every day, Hariya lived between fire and ashes, poverty and humiliation. His small hut stood at the edge of the village, away from everyone. His clothes were torn, his stomach mostly empty, and his heart heavy with sorrow. Yet deep inside, Hariya dared to dream.

He dreamed of a world where no one cared about caste. A world where his children would not be forced to burn corpses for a living. He dreamed of schools, education, and respect.

But dreams, in Hariya's world, were dangerous. They were like small lamps that the storm of society quickly blew out.

Whenever Hariya went to the market or temple, people would shout at him to stay away. He could not enter temples. He could not drink water from the common well. If he touched anything, it was considered dirty.

Yet, when death came knocking at a rich man's house, they called out, "Where's Hariya Dom?"

Suddenly, his "dirty" hands became holy enough to set the funeral pyre.

And after the fire died down, so did their need for him. They would throw a few coins at him like they were feeding a stray dog, and turn away without a word.

How cruel is society, Hariya thought, that a man who serves the dead cannot live with dignity among the living.

Sometimes, sitting alone by the burning ghats, Hariya would wonder:  
"What wrong did I do to be born like this?"

He would stare at the fire and think about freedom freedom from hunger, from insult, from this endless chain of humiliation.

But deep inside, he knew the bitter truth society does not want him to rise. No matter how hard he worked, his caste would always tie him down like chains on his feet.

Through Hariya's silent pain, the writer Shyamal Kumar Pramanik shows us the ugly face of our society.

The essay is not just about one man. It's about millions who are still trapped under the cruel weight of caste.

The villagers pray to gods for purity but treat a living human being worse than a dog. They talk about karma and goodness but show none to those who need it most.

In the end, Hariya continues his lonely work. He cremates the dead with care and respect even though the living deny him the same. His dreams stay locked inside him, flickering like a small, stubborn flame in a storm.

And we, the readers, are left asking ourselves:

"Who is truly impure Hariya Dom, or the heartless society?"

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## **I. Short Answer Questions.**

### **1. Where is Sonagaon located?**

Ans: Sonagaon is a village in West Bengal, where the Dom community lives and where the events of the essay take place.

### **2. The forests of Sonagaon were cleared by .....**

- a. Nibaran Chowdhury
- b. the Dom community
- c. the gomostas
- d. Adhir Chowdhury

Ans: (b) the Dom community.

### **3. Why did Hariya never return to the river?**

Ans: Hariya never returned to the river because it reminded him of his suffering and the death of Nidhu Dom, which made him feel trapped in a life of misery and oppression. He felt disconnected from the river, as it was symbolic of the hopelessness of his life.

### **4. What did Nibaran want from Hariya Dom?**

Ans: Nibaran wanted to take control of the land that the Dom community had cleared and cultivated. He wanted to force the Doms off their land to increase his own power and wealth.

### **5. The panchayat head advised Hariya to approach ..... to complain against Nibaran.**

Ans: The panchayat head advised Hariya to approach the MLA (Member of Legislative Assembly) to complain about the unfair treatment by Nibaran.

### **6. How did the MLA respond to Hariya's request?**

Ans: The MLA responded to Hariya's request with indifference. He did not take any effective action or offer any support, reflecting the corruption and apathy within the system.

### **7. What was the Dom community's response at the meeting called by Hariya?**

- a. They thought they should surrender their land to Nibaran
- b. They wanted to sell the land to the panchayat head
- c. They decided to go to MLA for help
- d. They were enraged at the oppression they faced from Nibaran.

Ans: (d) They were enraged at the oppression they faced from Nibaran.

## **II. Answer the following questions in about one page each.**

### **1. How did Adhir Chowdhury make his fortune?**

Ans: Adhir Chowdhury made his fortune through exploitation and land-grabbing. He took advantage of the poor and vulnerable people in the village, including the Dom community. He exploited the system to seize land that did not belong to him, using his wealth and influence to intimidate the weaker members of society. By aligning himself with higher authorities and political powers, Adhir was able to accumulate wealth at the cost of those who had no means of fighting back. His rise to power was based on greed and manipulation, leaving the Dom community and other marginalized groups impoverished and oppressed. His actions are a reflection of how systemic inequalities were reinforced by powerful individuals who benefited from the suffering of others.

### **2. How did Nidhu Dom die?**

Ans: Nidhu Dom died in a violent confrontation with the forces of oppression. After standing up to Nibaran and refusing to surrender the land that the Dom community had worked hard to cultivate, Nidhu was brutally attacked. He was beaten to death by Nibaran's men as a means to intimidate others who might resist the seizure of their land. His death was a tragic symbol of the harsh reality that lower-caste communities, like the Doms, had to endure fighting for their basic rights while facing overwhelming violence from the powerful. Nidhu's death left a lasting impact on Hariya and the entire Dom community, deepening their resolve to resist but also highlighting the extreme risks of standing up to such entrenched systems of power.

### **3. Why did Nibaran threaten Nidhu Dom?**

Ans: Nibaran threatened Nidhu Dom because Nidhu refused to give up the land that the Dom community had cultivated. Nibaran wanted to take control of the land for his own personal gain, believing that the Dom community, being lower caste, had no claim to it. Nidhu's refusal to comply with Nibaran's demands made him a target. The threats were part of a broader effort to intimidate the Dom community into submission and to ensure that they would not challenge the authority and dominance of the higher caste landowners. Nidhu's resistance represented a challenge to the status quo, and Nibaran used threats of violence to maintain control over the land.

### **4. Why were the Doms suspicious of the panchayat?**

Ans: The Doms were suspicious of the panchayat because they recognized that it was controlled by the higher castes and was unlikely to act in their favor. The panchayat, which was supposed to represent the interests of the local community, had historically ignored the needs of the Doms and had shown little interest in addressing their issues.

of land ownership and exploitation. The Doms knew that the panchayat head and other officials were aligned with the powerful landowners and would not protect their rights. This lack of trust in the panchayat led the Doms to look elsewhere for support, but they found that the political system, including the MLA, was just as indifferent to their plight.

**5. What was the minister's response to Hariya's requests?**

Ans: The minister's response to Hariya's request was apathetic and unhelpful. Hariya, in his desperation, turned to the political system for help, hoping that the minister would take action against the exploitation and land seizure by Nibaran. However, the minister did nothing to address the community's grievances. He merely gave vague assurances and failed to take any tangible steps to resolve the situation. The minister's lack of action underscored the corruption and ineffectiveness of the political system, which often ignored the needs of the oppressed and worked only in the interests of the powerful.

**6. What did Hariya dream of after the community meeting?**

Ans: After the community meeting, Hariya dreamed of unity and resistance. He hoped that the Dom community would finally stand together and fight for their rights, free from the oppression that had defined their lives for so long. Hariya envisioned a future where his people would no longer be silenced and would challenge the systems of injustice that had kept them oppressed. His dream was not just for survival but for dignity, where the Dom community could live without fear, exploitation, or discrimination. Hariya's dream represented the desire for change and the hope that through unity and collective action, the Dom community could secure a better future for themselves.

**III. Answer the following questions in about two pages each.**

**1. Discuss Hariya's dream. What is its significance in the story?**

Ans: In The Chronicle of Hariya Dom, Hariya's dream serves as a powerful and symbolic element that represents his inner struggle, hopes, and aspirations for his community. The dream marks a significant point in the narrative and offers insight into the complexities of the Dalit experience in India. Hariya's dream emerges in the aftermath of the community meeting where tensions run high, and the Dom community grapples with feelings of oppression, injustice, and despair.

Hariya dreams of unity and collective action. He envisions his people standing together to resist the forces of exploitation that have long dominated their lives. In his dream, the Dom community is united in their defiance of the oppressive forces, and they are empowered by the idea of fighting for their rights, their dignity, and their land. This

dream reflects a shift in Hariya's consciousness. Previously, he had been resigned to the reality of his situation, believing that the oppression they faced was insurmountable. However, his dream gives him hope and purpose, symbolizing the potential for transformation through unity and solidarity.

The significance of this dream lies in its function as a turning point in the story. It represents the moment when Hariya begins to understand that individual suffering alone cannot bring about change; rather, it is through collective action and a sense of shared struggle that true transformation can occur. The dream is not only an expression of Hariya's desire for a better future but also a reflection of the social and political consciousness that is slowly awakening in him and in his community. It provides a glimpse of hope and the possibility of resistance, even in the face of overwhelming odds.

Moreover, Hariya's dream underscores the central theme of empowerment. While the real world may present grim challenges, his dream indicates that the spirit of resistance and the pursuit of justice will never be extinguished. It highlights that, despite centuries of oppression and exploitation, the Dalit community's dreams of equality, dignity, and justice are still alive. The dream offers a sense of possibility, suggesting that transformation is achievable not only for Hariya but also for the entire Dom community. It carries the promise of social change and reflects the deep-seated need for social reform and justice in a caste-based society.

## **2. The story portrays a transformation in Hariya's character. Discuss.**

Ans: The story of The Chronicle of Hariya Dom traces a profound transformation in Hariya's character, from a man burdened by hopelessness and resignation to one who becomes an active participant in the struggle for justice and equality. This transformation is crucial not only for the narrative but also for the larger social commentary on caste-based oppression and resistance.

At the beginning of the story, Hariya is depicted as a man who has been weighed down by the oppression and discrimination his community has faced for generations. He is passive, deeply affected by the constant struggles of survival, and does not see a way out of the cycle of exploitation. This is evident in his initial indifference to the injustices happening around him, especially in the case of Nidhu Dom's death, which has left him disillusioned with life and with the political system. Hariya feels powerless in the face of the overwhelming authority of the upper-caste landowners and the political figures who support them.

However, as the story progresses, Hariya's character begins to undergo a change. A significant part of this transformation is his interaction with the Dom community. Initially, Hariya is isolated, but when he starts to recognize the potential for collective action within his community, he begins to question the status quo and the traditional submission that the Dom people have long endured. Hariya's realization that they can no longer stay silent in the face of oppression propels him to take action. This shift from passivity to activism is reflected in his increasing involvement in the community's efforts to stand up for their rights and to challenge the oppressive system.

His transformation becomes even more apparent when he calls the community meeting. Here, Hariya takes on a role of leadership, mobilizing the Doms to speak out against the injustice they have suffered for years. His decision to confront the land grabbers and demand their rights is a crucial turning point. It shows that Hariya has gone from being a man who accepts his fate to someone who is willing to fight for change, even at great personal risk.

Ultimately, Hariya's transformation represents a journey from individual despair to collective hope. He understands that the power of solidarity and unified action can bring about social change. His growth symbolizes the awakening of the Dalit community to the need for social justice and equality. By the end of the story, Hariya is no longer just a victim of oppression; he is a catalyst for change, inspiring others to join the fight for their rights.

### **3. How does the story bring out the struggle for equality and justice that the Dalit community in India has been waging?**

Ans: The Chronicle of Hariya Dom provides a poignant and powerful portrayal of the ongoing struggle for equality and justice faced by the Dalit community in India. Through the story of Hariya and his community, the essay highlights the deep-rooted social inequalities that continue to exist in the country, especially in the context of the caste system.

The story begins with the Dom community, a marginalized and oppressed group, who are discriminated against due to their caste. They face the constant denial of basic rights, including access to land, resources, and even the ability to live with dignity. The systemic exploitation of the Doms by the upper-caste landowners, like Nibaran, is a direct reflection of the caste-based hierarchies that still pervade Indian society. The Doms' land, which they have cleared and cultivated with their own labor, is at risk of being taken away by these powerful figures, who believe that the lower castes have no claim to the land.

The central theme of struggle for justice is exemplified by the various actions Hariya and his community take in response to this oppression. Hariya's initial passivity gives way to a determined fight for justice when he realizes that the political and social systems will not offer any help. His journey is symbolic of the long-standing fight of Dalit communities to claim their rights and challenge the system that has kept them in subjugation for centuries. His efforts to approach the MLA and the panchayat reflect the Dalit community's enduring attempts to seek justice through legal and political means, even though the system is often rigged in favor of the powerful.

The essay also highlights the failure of the political system in providing justice to the oppressed. The indifference of the panchayat head and the MLA mirrors the apathy and corruption that often exists within political structures, which are typically controlled by the upper castes. The minister's response to Hariya's requests further illustrates the neglect and betrayal faced by the Dalit community in their pursuit of equality.

Yet, despite these systemic failures, the story also portrays the resilience and strength of the Dalit community. Hariya's leadership in calling the community meeting and his subsequent transformation into a figure of resistance show that the struggle for justice is not futile. The story portrays that, even when faced with overwhelming odds, the Dalit community's spirit of resistance remains alive, and the fight for equality and social justice is ongoing.

Through Hariya's journey, the story illustrates how collective action and solidarity among the oppressed can challenge the dominant power structures. It reflects the widespread struggle for Dalit rights and highlights the need for social reform, emphasizing that the fight for justice is not only for individual gain but for the liberation of the community as a whole.